



SpaceX testing cultivated meat

SpaceX and Aleph Farms begin testing cultivated meat in space.
<https://digit.in/apr22-23>



Xenotransplantation

New advancements indicate that genetically modified pigs could be the future of organ transplants. <https://digit.in/apr22-24>

Synology DiskStation DS120j NAS

It's personal

Google shutting down their free photo upload feature in Android smartphones has caused millions of people to seek alternative image hosting services. And services that can match Google Photo with regards to retention of image quality, running AI-based algorithms to classify images and even the people and objects within them, etc. are rare. What if you could simply buy a gadget that did it all and even kept your data private? That's what you get with Synology NAS devices and the DS120j that we're looking at today is one of the cheapest units that you can get to replace Google Photos and get a lot more functionalities as well.

BUILD QUALITY

The Synology DS120j is a simple 1-bay NAS that's meant to be your personal and smart image hosting service. It features a 2-part plastic shell casing that can be slid open to reveal one HDD installation bay. On the inside, we get to see a metal chassis to hold the HDD down. Since this is an economical 1-bay NAS, there isn't a drive caddy that can slide in and out as we've seen with most of the higher-end NAS devices. Being a single-bay NAS means that you don't get to hot-swap HDDs because it's nonsensical in such a situation.

At the end of the HDD bay is a single 60mm YS Tech cooling fan which is rated to run at 3100 RPM and produce under 22 dB(A) which is very quiet during operation. The plastic outer shell has a nice Synology logo cut into one of the sides which doubles up as ventilation slits to keep the hard drive cool. The case can be put together and secured using just two screws, which is again, quite convenient.

The DS120j is powered using a Marvell Armada 3700 88F3720 and has 512 GB of DDR3L memory. The hardware is very dated but when you're making a device affordable for the



Price
₹16,900

masses, then we can term the hardware to be quite capable. Also, compared to its predecessor, the DS119j, this is double the memory. Sure, there are certain tasks such as transcoding movies that will not work optimally on such hardware. Also, with just 512MB of DDR3L RAM, you will be relegated to running very few apps or services simultaneously on the NAS.

The front of the unit has a couple of LEDs to indicate status and display errors. On the back, we've got 2 USB ports and one GbE LAN port. There's also a Kensington lock slot right next to the ethernet port as well.

PERFORMANCE

We used a 1TB SATA SSD for the benchmarks and installed the latest Synology DSM 7.0 operating system on the unit. Setting up the unit is very fast and you can be easily up and running in less than an hour.

Our drive transfer tests resulted in 111 MB/s write speeds and 112 MB/s read speeds from the unit. We can't run the typical RAID benchmarks since this is a single-bay NAS so we switched to our simultaneous access benchmarks. The unit can easily

serve four full HD streams simultaneously.

As for power consumption, running the NAS using an SSD works out to be very power efficient but we switched out the SSD for an HDD to see how much more the unit could consume. We saw a peak consumption of just 12 W when the NAS was being taxed with a massive file transfer.

We then tried out the Synology Photos application which is one of the key reasons for getting a unit like this. Transferring photos to the NAS is all you need to do. If you've nicely catalogued and organised your photos, then there's nothing like it. But if you haven't, the Synology Photos app does a great work of

sorting the photos as well. It might not be to your liking but if you're someone who just clicks photos and let's Google do all the thinking, then the Synology Photos app does a pretty job of organising the photos, just like Google's Photos app.

VERDICT

The Synology DS120j is a great personal storage device for your precious moments. It's still powered by DSM 7.0 which outperforms all NAS operating systems out in the market. Only the hardware is a little dated but for the price, it's a great deal.

—Mithun Mohandas

SPECIFICATIONS

CPU: Marvell Armada 3700 88F3720 | RAM: 512 MB DDR3L | BAYS: 1 | HOT SWAP SUPPORT: NA | I/O: 2x USB 2.0 | LAN PORTS: 1x Gigabit | WEIGHT: 0.7 kg | FAN: 1x 92 mm | WARRANTY: 2 years.

CONTACT

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